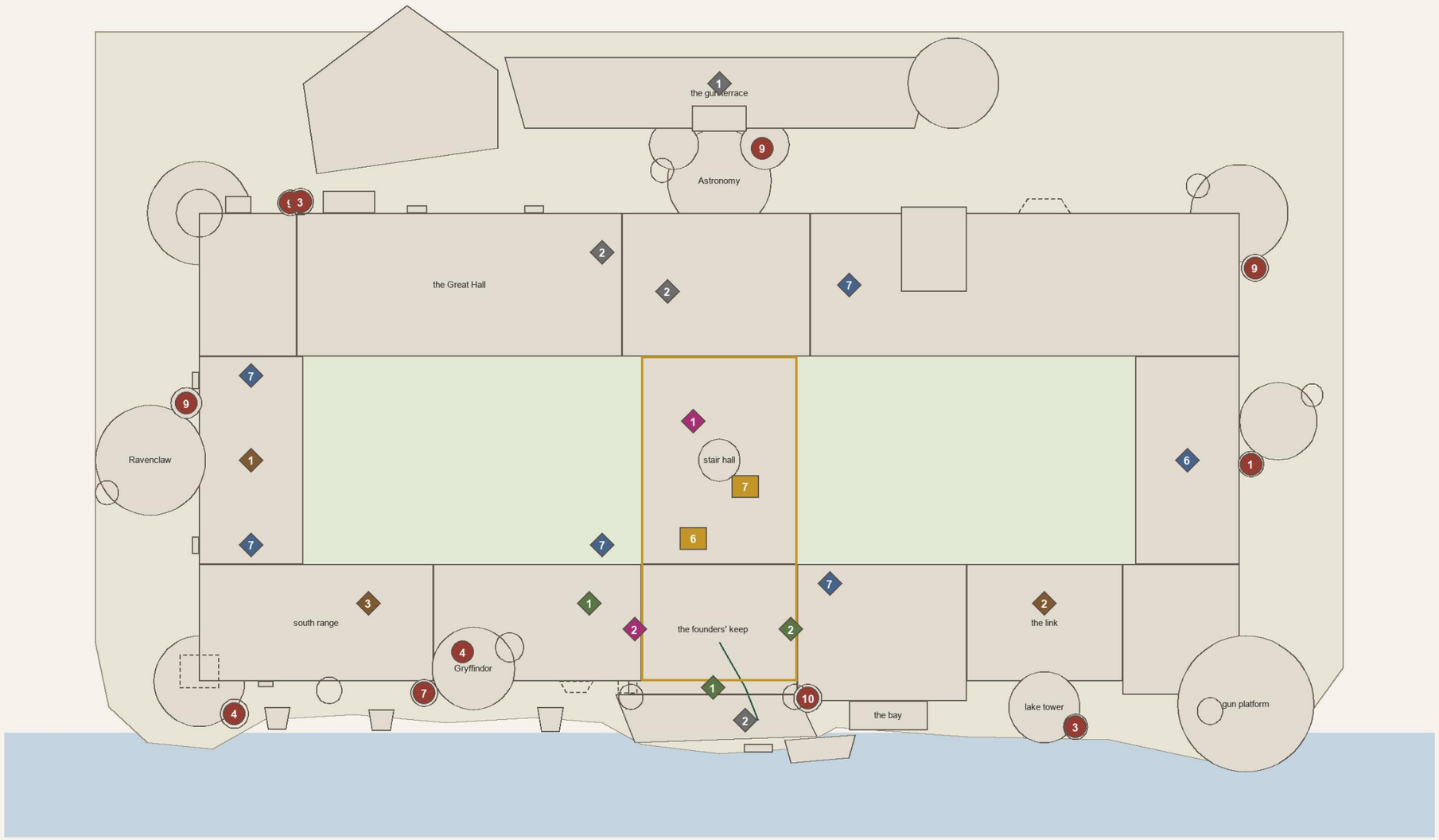
The 142 staircases: through the whole castle, not one well

The Architect, 13 October 2026, for Godric. Under 6.1 and 7.1 (Godric, 7.13 and 7.18 am). One staircase is one stair from a floor to the next landing. Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

Canon, checked at the gate: "There were a hundred and forty-two staircases at Hogwarts: wide, sweeping ones; narrow, rickety ones; some that led somewhere different on a Friday; some with a vanishing step halfway up" (PS 8).

Corrected: the well holds 14 of them (the marble staircase, six moving flights and the Friday one); the other 128 stand through the towers and ranges. Every stair marked where it stands, whatever its floor; 1:750.



The tally, 142 in all

13 Wide, sweeping: the marble staircase and the moving flights, in the stair hall's well

- 7 the marble staircase: from the Entrance Hall, facing the front doors, on up to the seventh (PS 7, HBP 24)
- 6 the moving flights: between the well's landings, swinging; the "swivelling staircase" (OotP 32)

68 Spiral stairs in the towers and their turrets (Ravenclaw's, DH 29: "tight, dizzying circles")

- 1 the head's: the moving spiral behind the gargoyle, the one the books show moving (CoS 11)
- 9 Ravenclaw: its turret, G to the tower top (DH 29)
- 9 Astronomy: steep, from the east drum at +18 to the top (PS 14)
- 9 North Tower: its turret to the seventh, then the narrow spiral to the silver ladder (PoA 6, GoF 13)
- 9 West Tower: up to the Owlery (GoF 15)
- 7 Gryffindor's angle turret: G to the seventh
- 4 Gryffindor's dormitories: boys' 2, girls' 2 (the girls' melts into a slide) (PS 7, OotP 17)
- 10 the keep's: harbour level to the bartizans
- 4 the south-west: clinging from 20 m up
- 3 the lake tower: the restorers' turret
- 3 the north-west: from 30 m up

41 Straight and dog-leg stairs in the ranges, at the courts' corners

- 7 west range, south: G to 7
- 7 west range, north: G to 7
- 7 south range, by the keep: G to 7
- 7 hall range, by the keep: G to 7
- 6 east range: G to 6
- 7 north range, east: G to 7

6 Narrow, rickety ones: timber stairs in the Tudor lodgings and the gallery storey

- 3 the Tudor lodgings: timber, floors 4 to 7
- 1 the gallery storey: timber, up into the gallery
- 2 the link of 1647: timber, its upper floors

4 Hidden ones in the founders' 3 m walls, behind tapestries and panels: the short cuts

- 1 the tapestry stair to Gryffindor: "a door concealed behind a tapestry", narrower (GoF 12)
- 2 in the keep's east wall: a mural stair behind a panel
- 1 in the keep's south wall: beside the great window

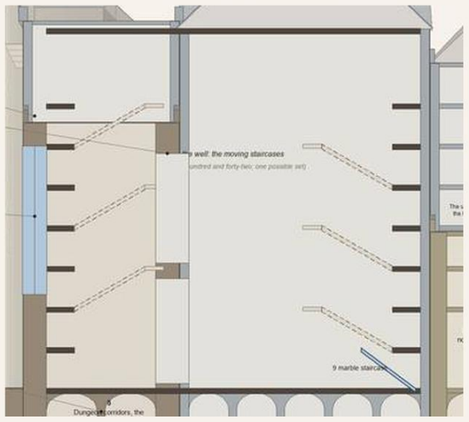
7 Down: to the dungeons, the kitchens and the harbour; the stone steps up to the front doors

- 2 to the dungeons: "a narrow stone staircase" from the Entrance Hall (CoS 5)
- 2 to the kitchens and Hufflepuff: steps down to the basement corridor (GoF 21, OotP 18)
- 1 the stone steps: up to the oak front doors (PS 6)
- 2 from the harbour: the boats' passage up through the rock; the founders' stair walled up (PS 6)

3 The odd ones of PS 8: the Friday staircase, the vanishing step

- 1 the Friday staircase: one of the well's flights: on a Friday it swings to another landing (PS 8)
- 2 the vanishing step: a concealed stair in the keep's west wall, two floors, behind tapestries (GoF 25, HBP 28)

Now: A-A as drawn at 12.15 am (sections-0015, page 2), its well labelled with all 142



Corrected: the same cut (sections-0735, page 1): the well holds 14, the rest through the castle

